

Probably not—it's difficult to recall these words. By contrast, words starting with a *k* spring effortlessly to mind. Naturally, words that start with a *k* must therefore be more prevalent in the English alphabet, right? Wrong. There are three times as many words that have *k* in the third position in the English language than there are words beginning with *k*.⁵

We see availability bias in a number of contexts when there is an availability *shock* in the news media. Two examples include the Fukushima Nuclear Disaster in Japan (see [Figure 3.6](#)) and the BP oil spill in the Gulf of Mexico (see [Figure 3.7](#)).